

Workbook: The Spinal Cord

Week 8 workbook • BIO 004 Human Anatomy • Dr. Sharilyn Rennie • Solano Community College

A comprehensive workbook on the spinal cord: its gross anatomy, internal structure, the tracts it carries, the spinal nerves it gives off, and basic clinical anatomy.

How to use this workbook: Read each question carefully and write your answer in the space provided. Work without looking up the answer first. Once you have written your answer, check it against the online workbook by clicking *Reveal* on that question. Star or circle anything you missed and come back to it later in the week.

Gross anatomy • 3 questions

Q01 • DOK 1 • Recall

Where does the spinal cord begin and end in the adult, and why does it end where it does?

Q02 • DOK 1 • Recall

What are the cervical and lumbar enlargements, and why are they there?

Q03 • DOK 1 • Recall

What is the cauda equina, and what is the filum terminale?

Internal structure • 3 questions

Q04 • DOK 1 • Recall

Describe the internal structure of the spinal cord in cross section.

Q05 • DOK 1 • Recall

Compare dorsal and ventral roots of a spinal nerve.

Q06 • DOK 2 • Compare

Compare ascending and descending tracts in the spinal cord.

Spinal nerves and clinical • 3 questions**Q07 • DOK 1 • Recall**

How many spinal nerves are there, and how are they numbered?

Q08 • DOK 1 • Recall

What is a dermatome?

Q09 • DOK 3 • Reason

A lumbar puncture inserts a needle between L3 and L4 (or L4 and L5) into the subarachnoid space. Using cord anatomy, explain why this level is safe.

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